



Ubuntu Live CDs were shipped worldwide by Canonical. That was a great push!

you could update your OS to the latest version without having to reinstall it via a DVD or USB drive. While this might look like a small change, it is what attracted aspiring geeks (and soon-to-be hardcore techies) to Ubuntu. Some fell in love with code while others drooled over the awesomeness of Linux administration. And as with any culture, all you had to do to gain mass following was to target the experts within the culture, the rest follow. Ubuntu, in that sense hit the right note. Though its interface was simple, the innards were very powerful (it was still Linux, after all).

Hardware no longer giving a hard time

While all of this was happening, many drivers were being created for the Linux kernel. This was one of the fastest growth periods for Linux. The number of crashes and hangs being reported by users slowly began to decline. Though there were unstable drivers, the fixes were faster than ever. Networking was being stabilised thanks to new tools and network managers that came with desktop managers such as GNOME and KDE.

Besides this, graphics cards manufacturers such as NVIDIA and ATI had also started releasing drivers for Linux. You could finally play one of those Mario clones without crashing your system! Finally, you could plug